Building an AI-Resilient Workforce

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Wednesday, April 29, 2026

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What are we going to talk about?

- **Landscape of AI in software testing today**
  - Diffusion of innovation
  - AI Spectrum
- **Tool changes**
  - Impact on existing tools
  - Agentic workflows
  - Dangers of speed
- **Team structures**
  - Evolving roles
  - Evolving teams
  - Evolving hiring

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Testing is Dead… Again…

The Headlines say so

CIO

Topics | Spotlight: Managing modern risks | Events | Newsletters | Resour

5 dead-end IT skills – and how to avoid becoming obsolete

Feature

Medium

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Could it all be over for us?

AI Built My App — Is Software Engineering Dead?

Theo McCabe · Follow

5 min read · Apr 1, 2024

BUSINESS INSIDER

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The AI coding apocalypse

In the age of artificial intelligence, entry-level coders may be doomed. But some engineers are thriving.

SOFTWARE TESTING

Has AI Finally Destroyed the Need for Software Testing?

2025-04-08 | 6 min read

Forbes

SMALL BUSINESS > SMALL BUSINESS STRATEGY

Business Tech News: Zuckerberg Says AI Will Replace Mid-Level Engineers Soon

By Gene Marks, Contributor. I write about tech that impacts my small busine...

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Jan 26, 2025, 07:00am EST

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Timeline

2000

Automated testing will eliminate testers

2010

Agile means developers test everything

2011

Test is Dead

(Alberto Savoia – GTAC)

2012

How Google tests software
(James Whittaker)

2020's

AI tools will replace testers

LLMs will write your tests automatically

2026

We're still here!

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Danger Ahead

- **Redundancies**
- **Reduced Test : Dev Ratios**
- **Reduced Test Involvement**
- **Shifting Responsibilities**

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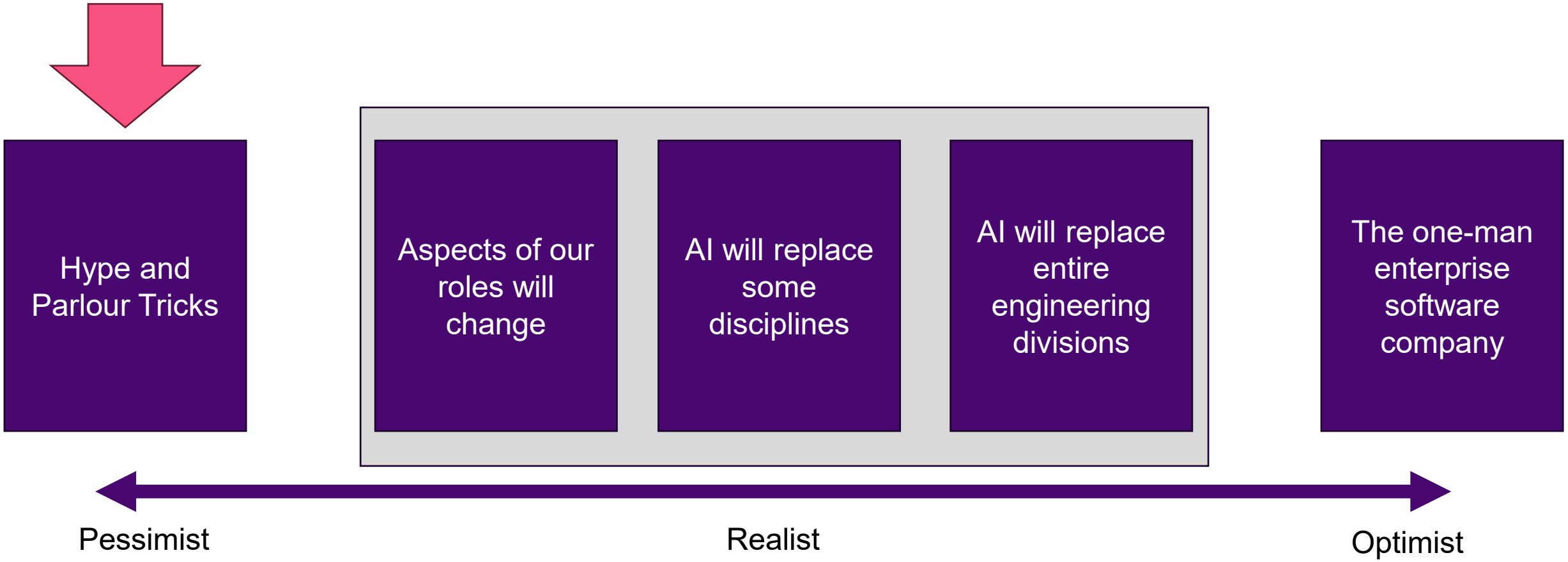
AI Spectrum



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Prepare for change

Where do you sit on the AI spectrum today?

Where does your team and organisation sit?

Perspectives change

Understand that this is moving – and moving fast

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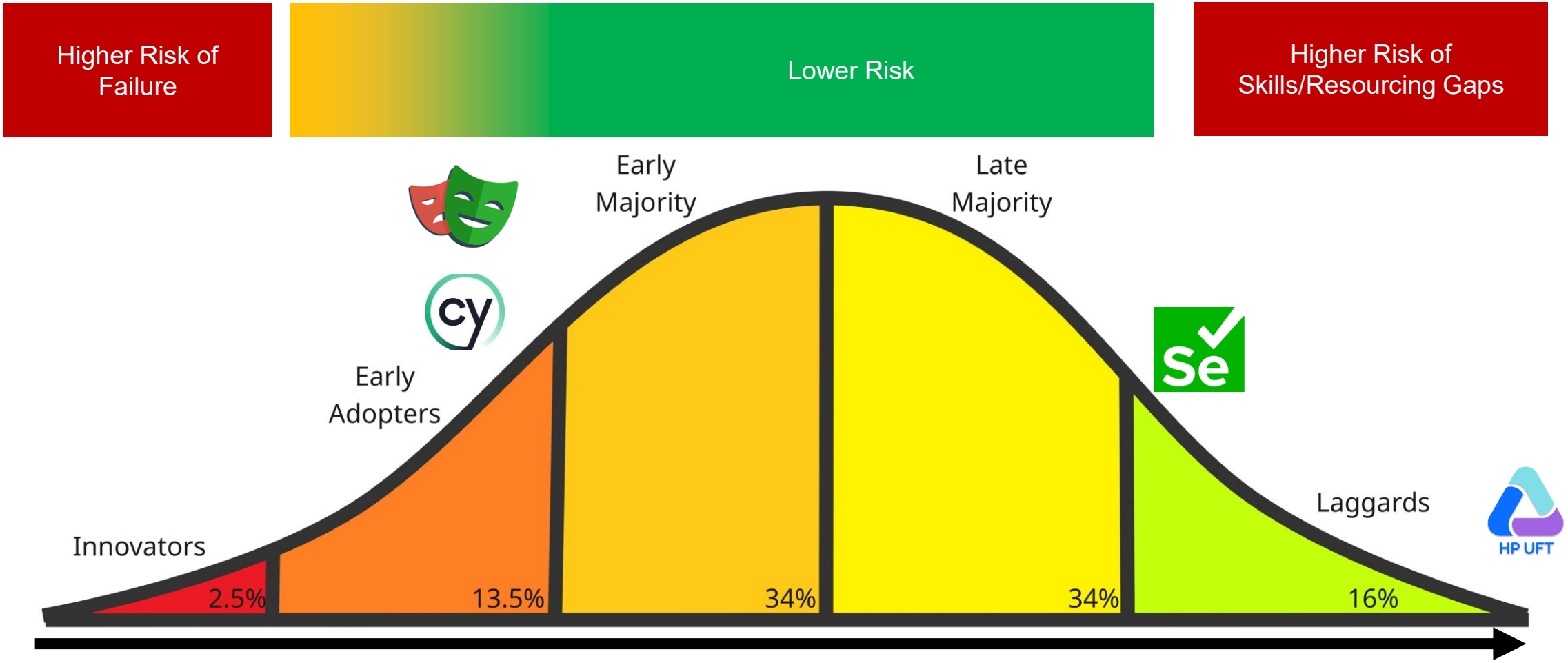
Riding the wave

Diffusion of Innovations, Everett Rogers (1962)



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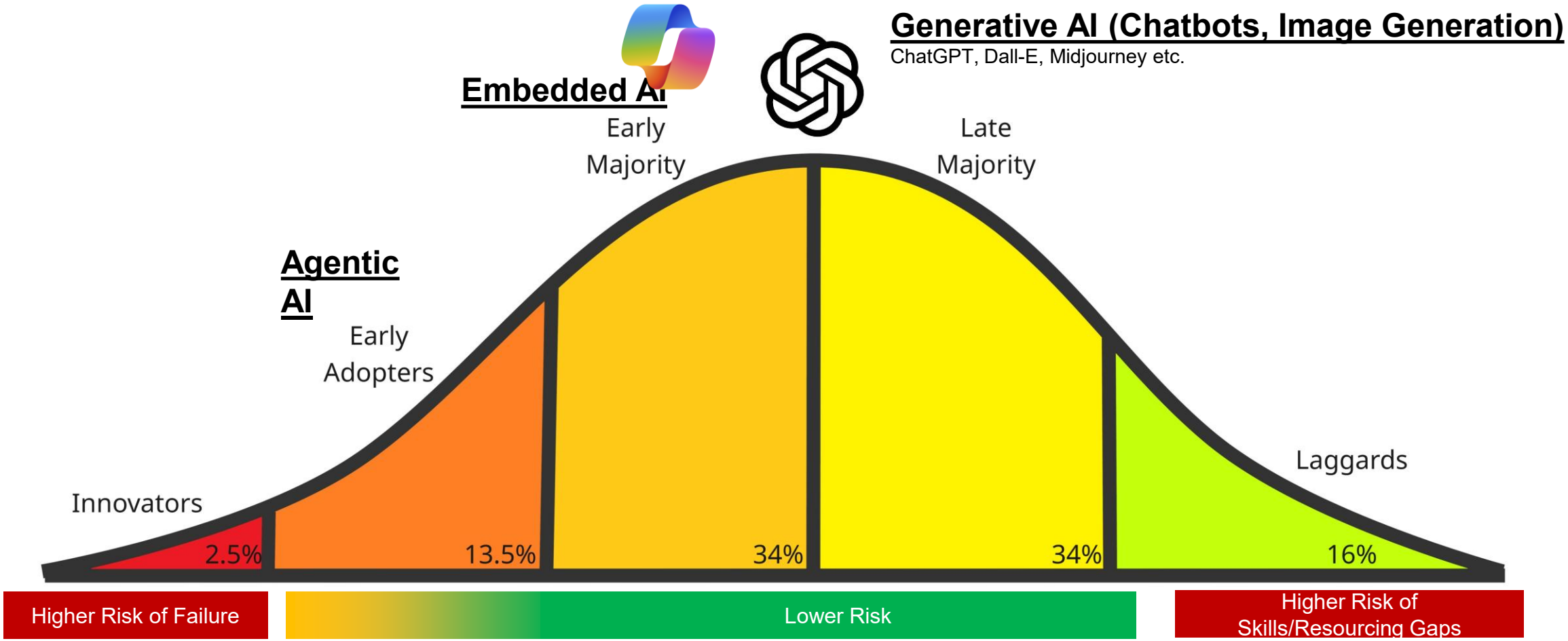
Riding the wave

"AI is just another wave of software tools/capabilities"



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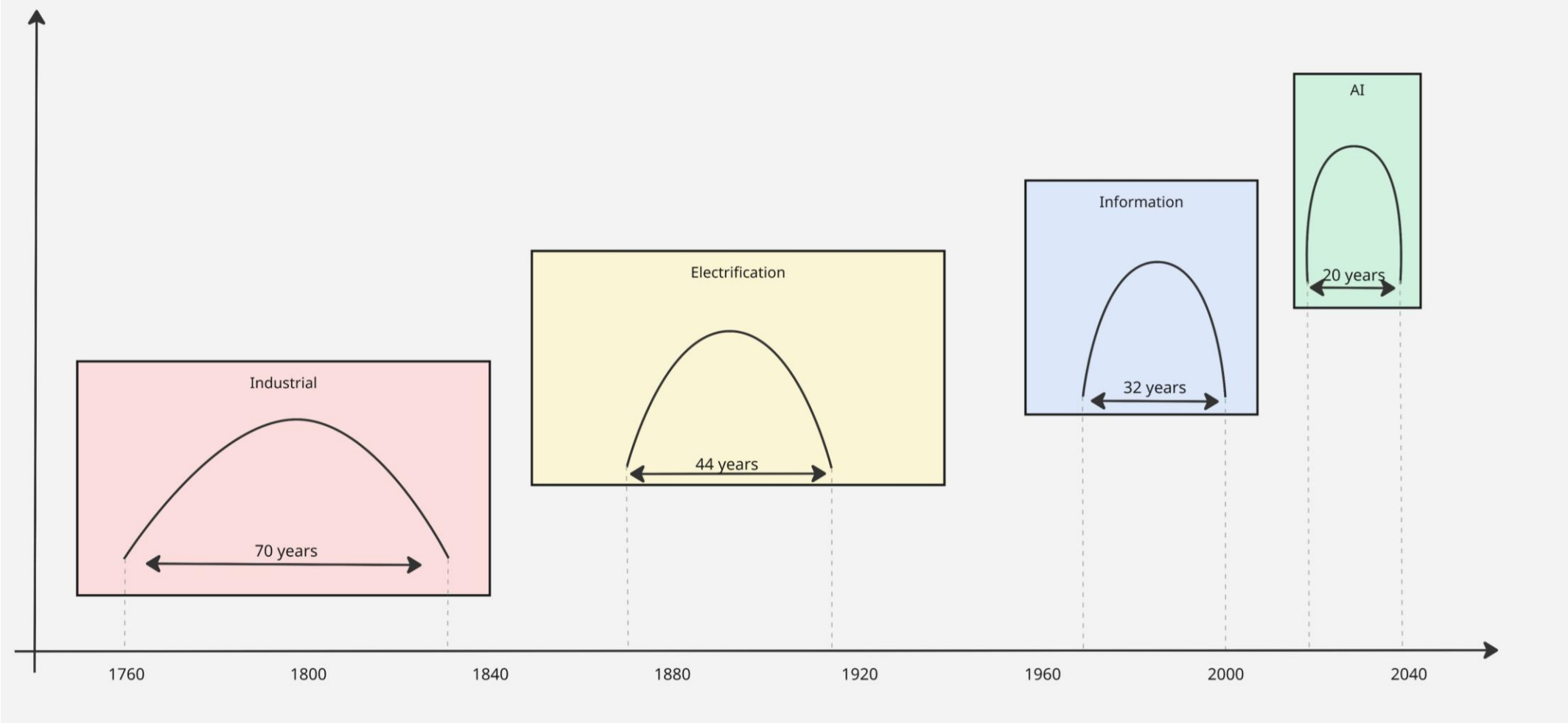
Riding the wave

Pace of innovation is ever increasing



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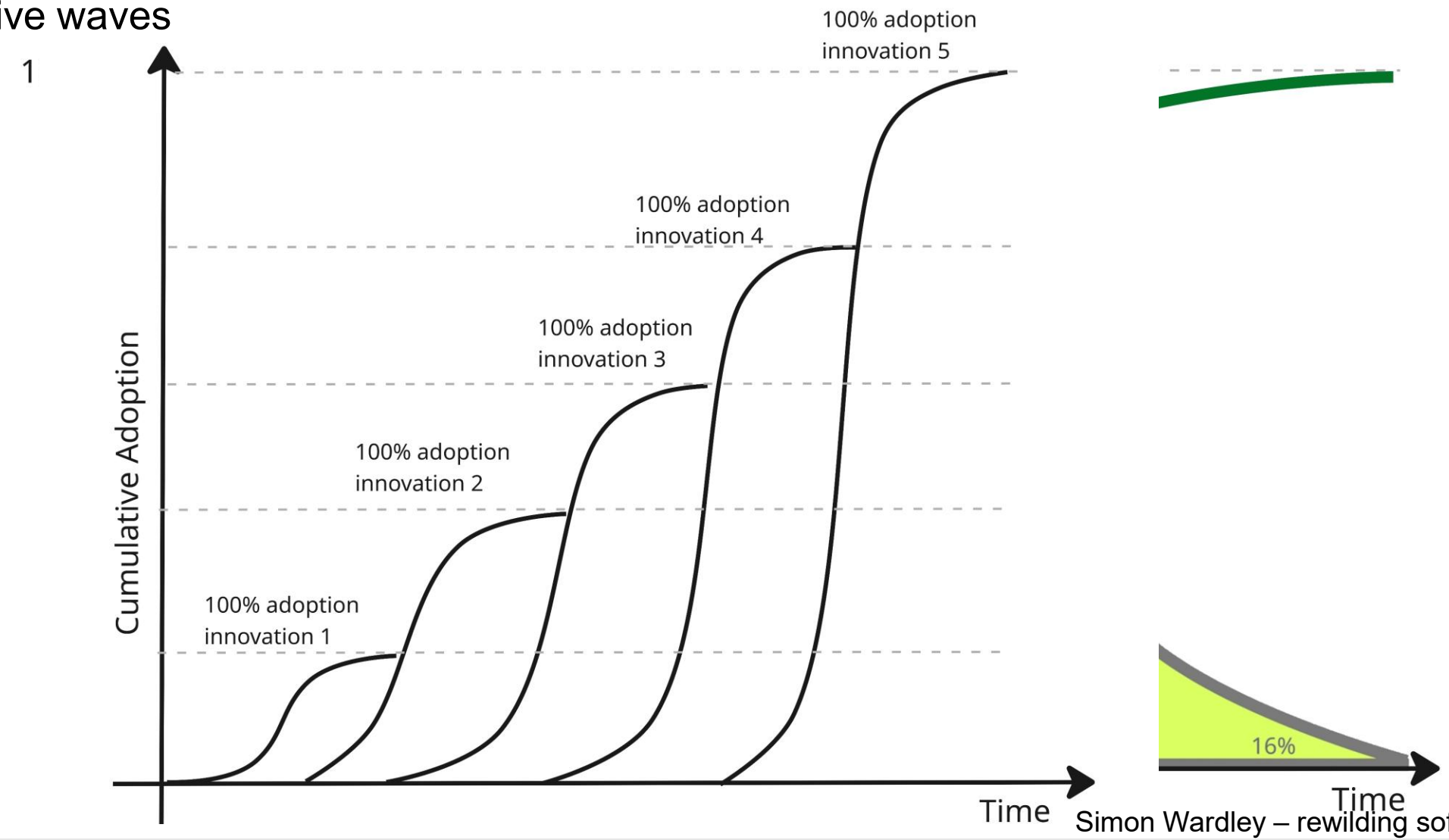
Riding the wave

Iterative waves



Simon Wardley – rewilding software engineering

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Testing Tool Changes

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“Job spec updated: must have 8 arms.”

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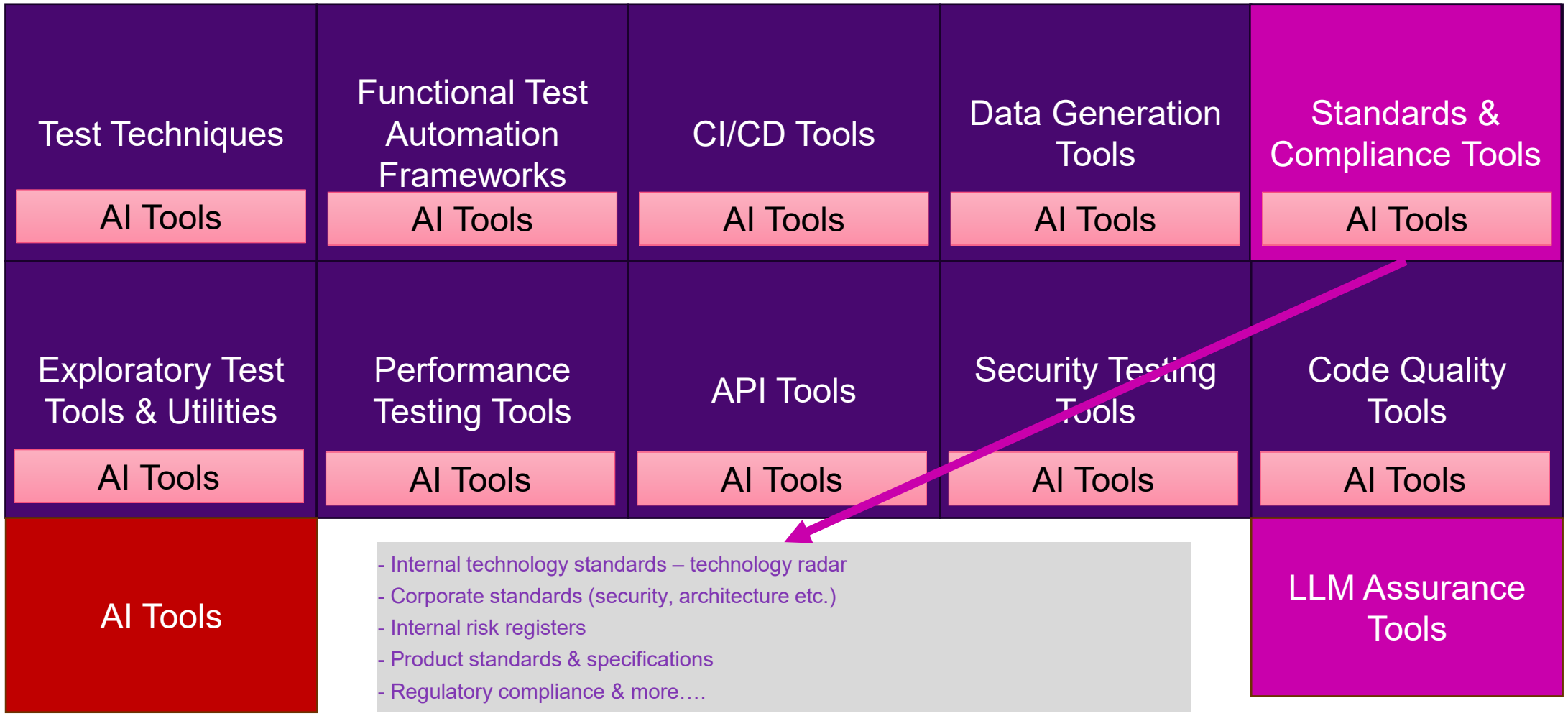
Testing Toolkit



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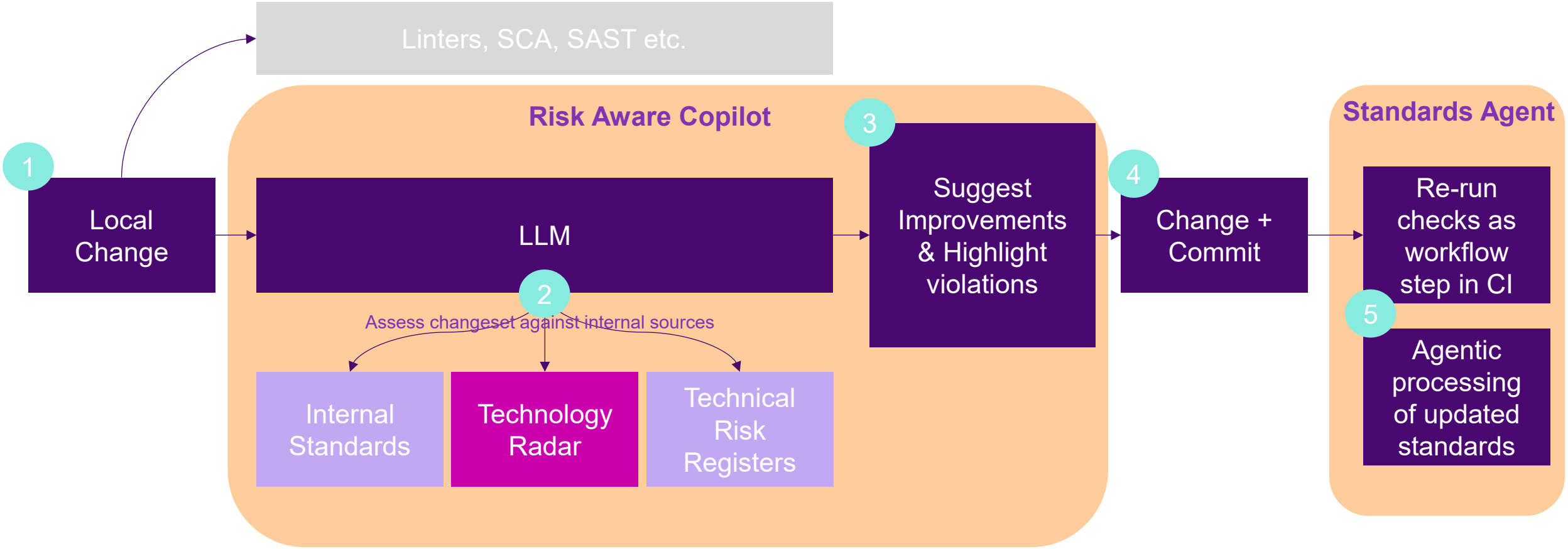
AI Copilots & Agents

Risk Aware Copilot – a RAG based AI tool (late 2024)



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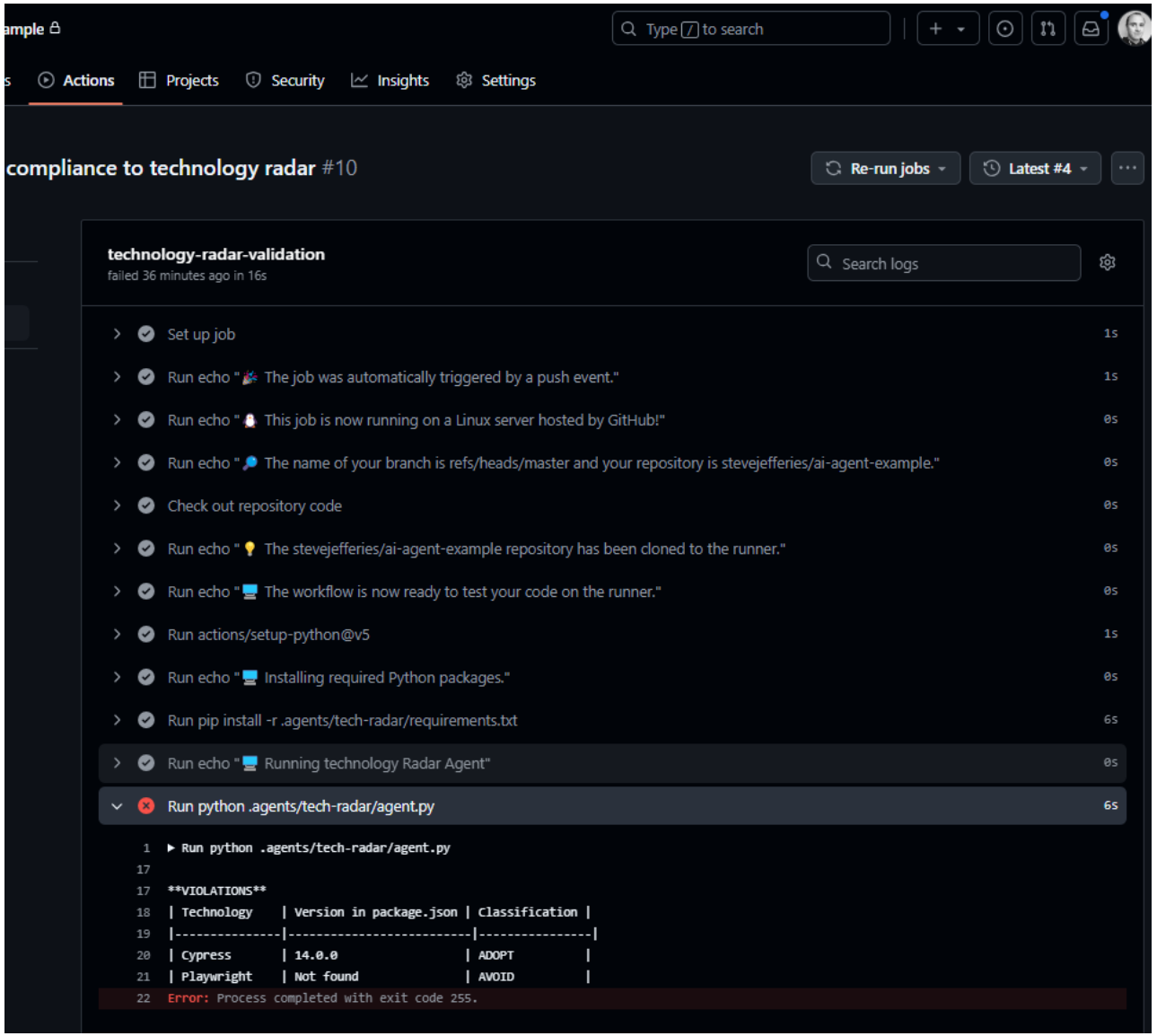
AI Copilots & Agents

An additional safety net, not a replacement for the human in the loop.

Challenges:

- Hallucinations still prevalent
- Skills gaps – to build and maintain
- Initial data quality
- Human in the loop complacency
- Testing & confidence in an AI agent for compliance



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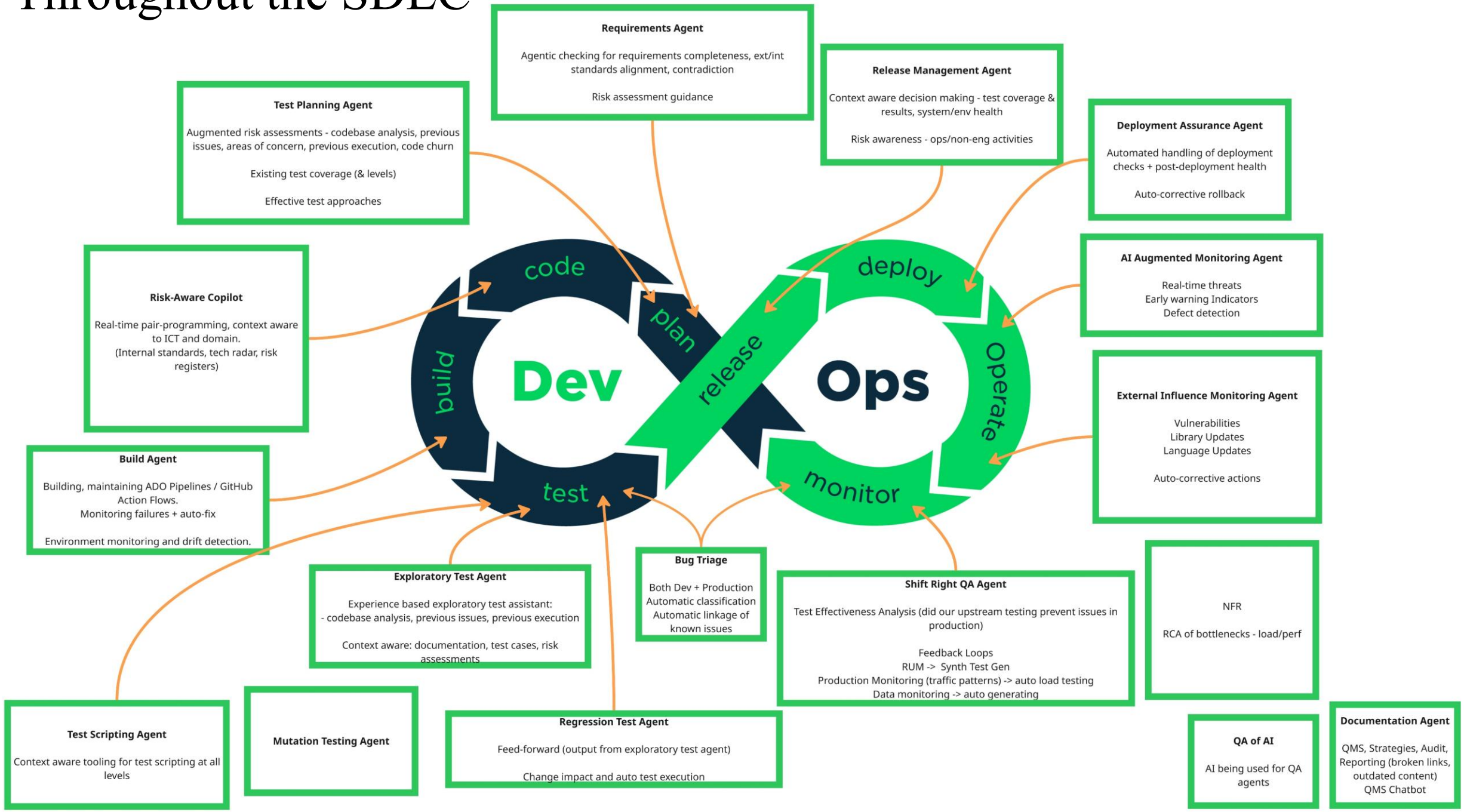
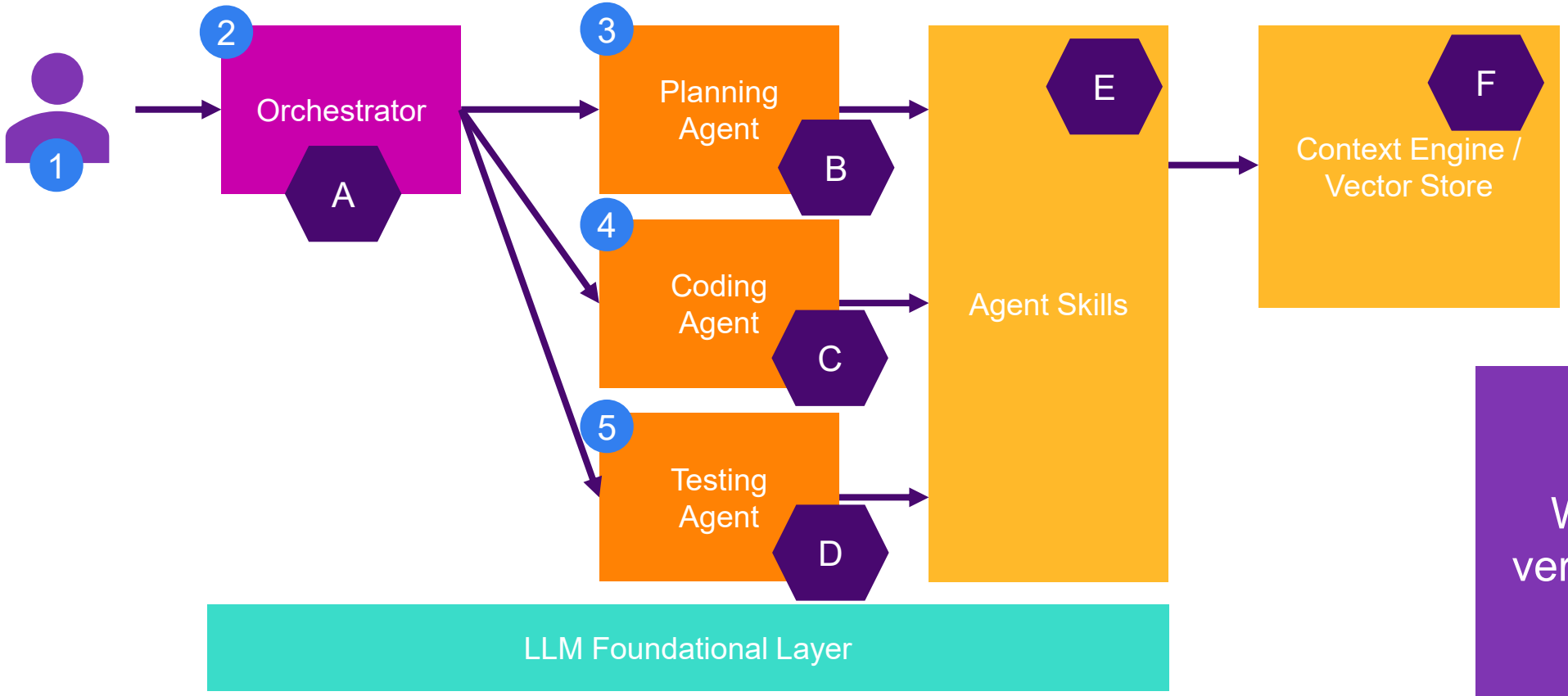
AI Throughout the SDLC



Agentic Workflows – HITL etc.

The “next wave” – rapidly growing since 2024



Where do we verify the output?

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Agentic Workflows

The hidden costs of agentic speed

The Autonomy-Assurance Paradox
the more we delegate, the more we must verify

The Intuition Collapse
if humans didn't write it, humans can't just eyeball it

The Testing Explosion
testing must be focused and layered

The Cognitive Load Trap
AI lowers the cost of creation, at the cost of comprehension

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Agentic AI

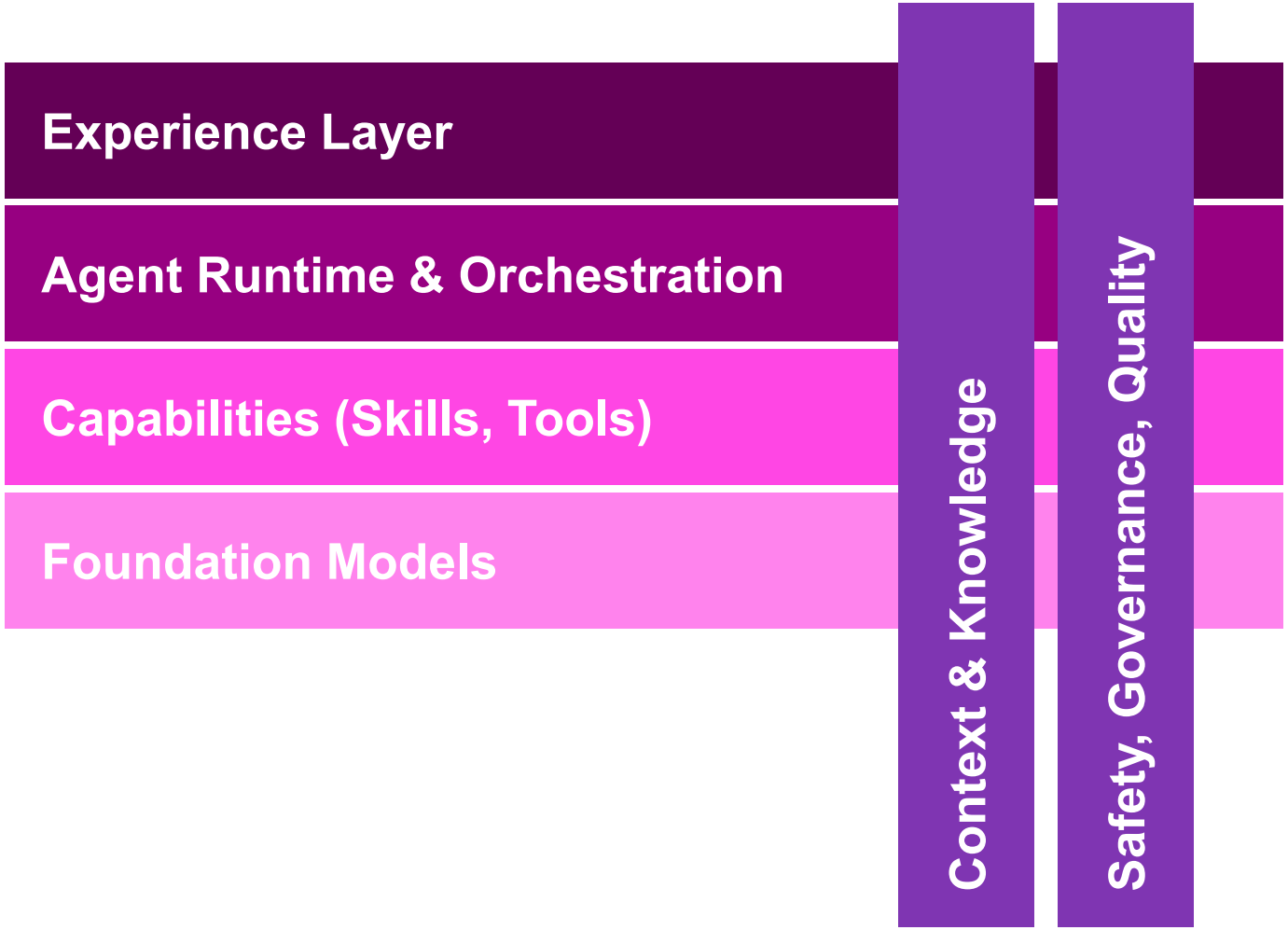
Layering your solution

Agentic solutions are becoming complex multi layered ecosystems.

Challenge: what tools do you adopt?

AI arms race to provide “enterprise” grade solutions.

Focus on the layers in turn – getting each right and combining is the key to success.



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People, Teams, Recruitment

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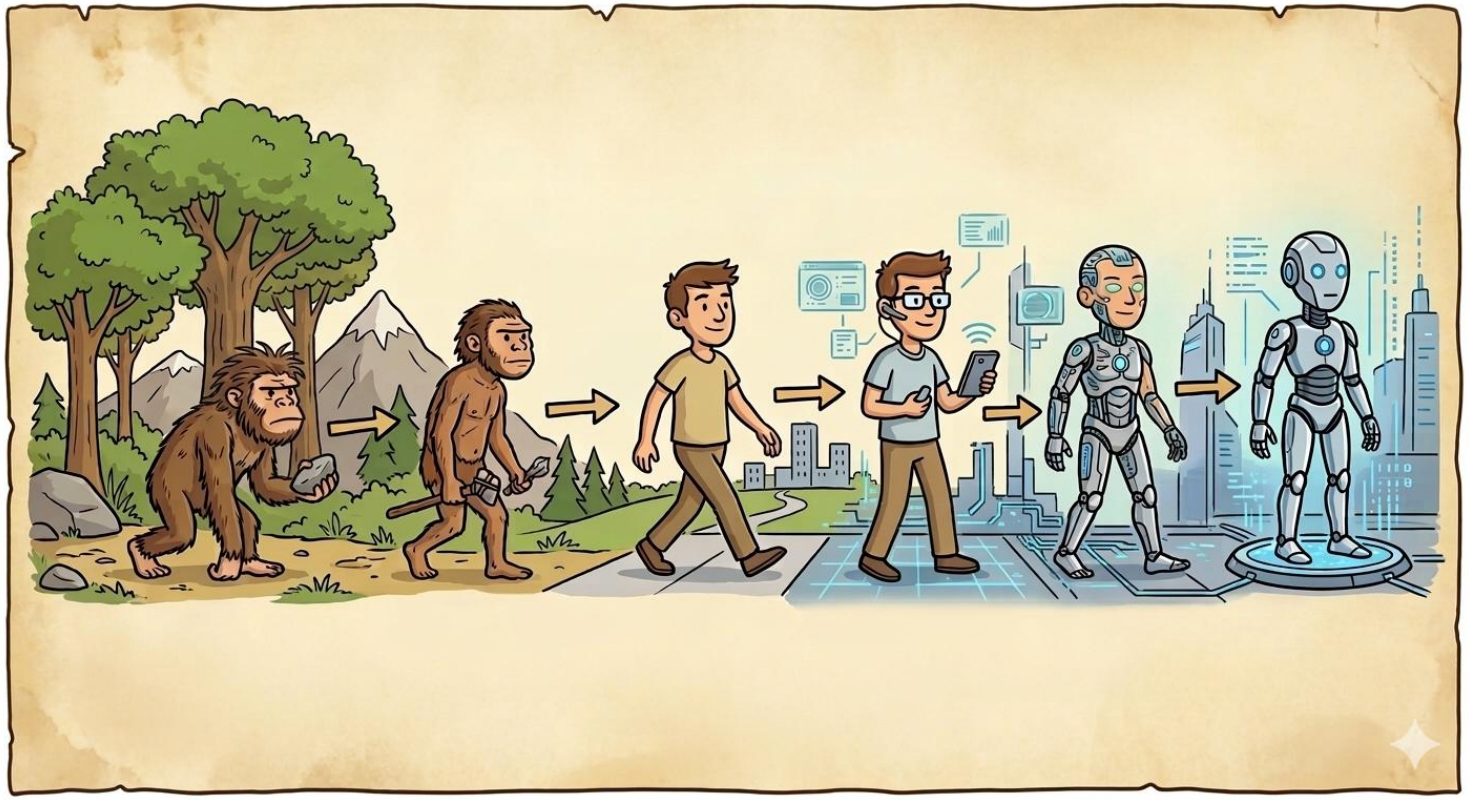
“Do we need SDET’s anymore? Is this role being replaced by AI?”

What does an SDET even do?!

- **Automating “manual” test scripts**
- **Building/Maintaining test frameworks**
- **Test case design and approach (test levels)**
- **Codebase improvements**
- **Code reviews**
- **CI pipeline development/maintenance**



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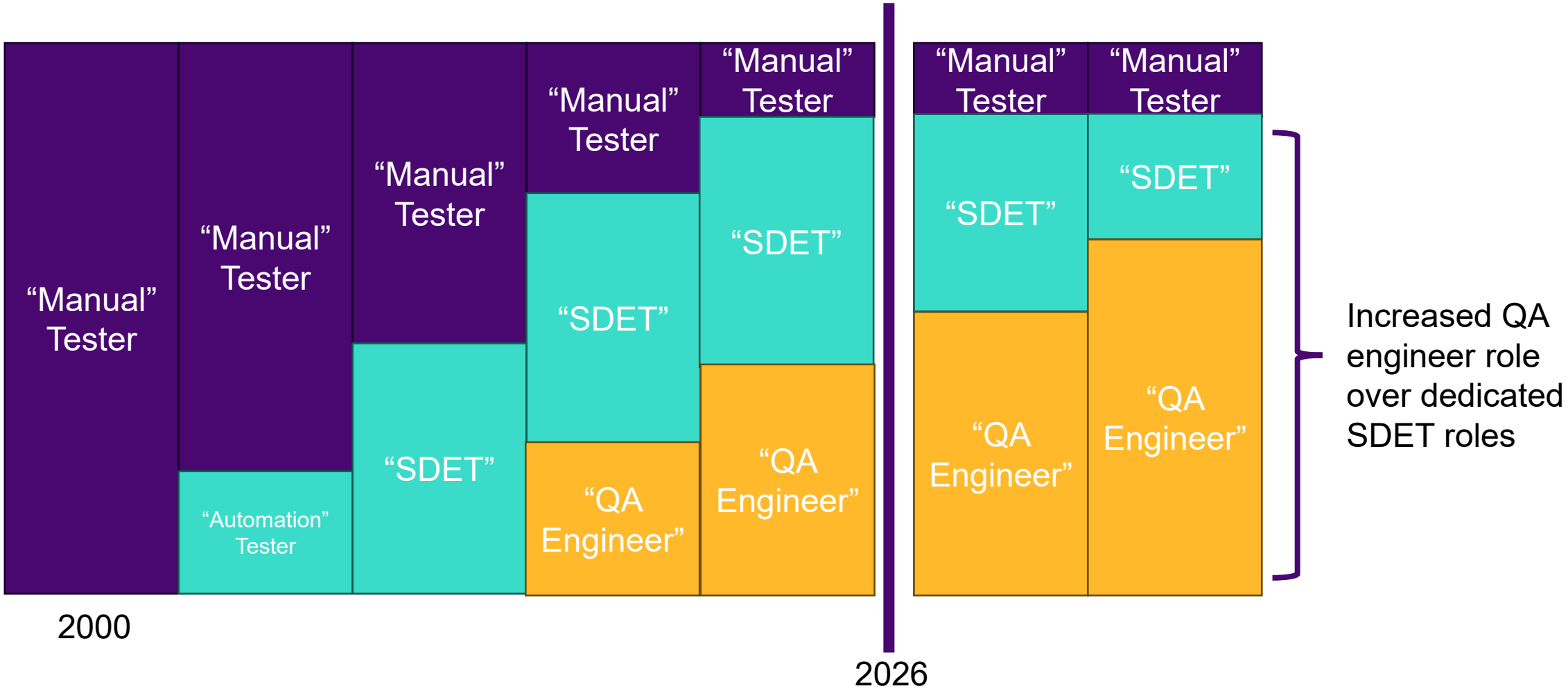
A look to the past



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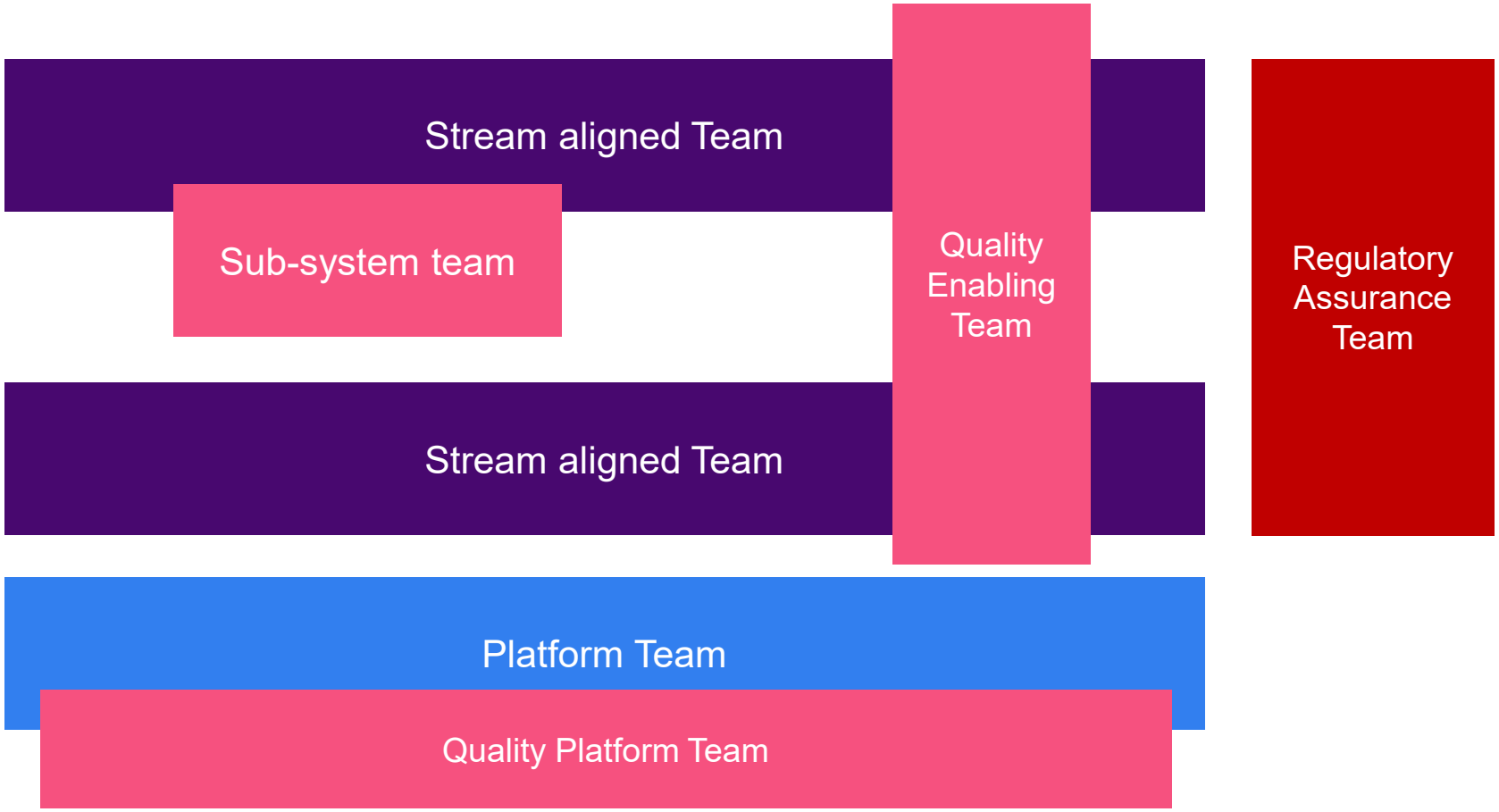
Evolving Team Landscape



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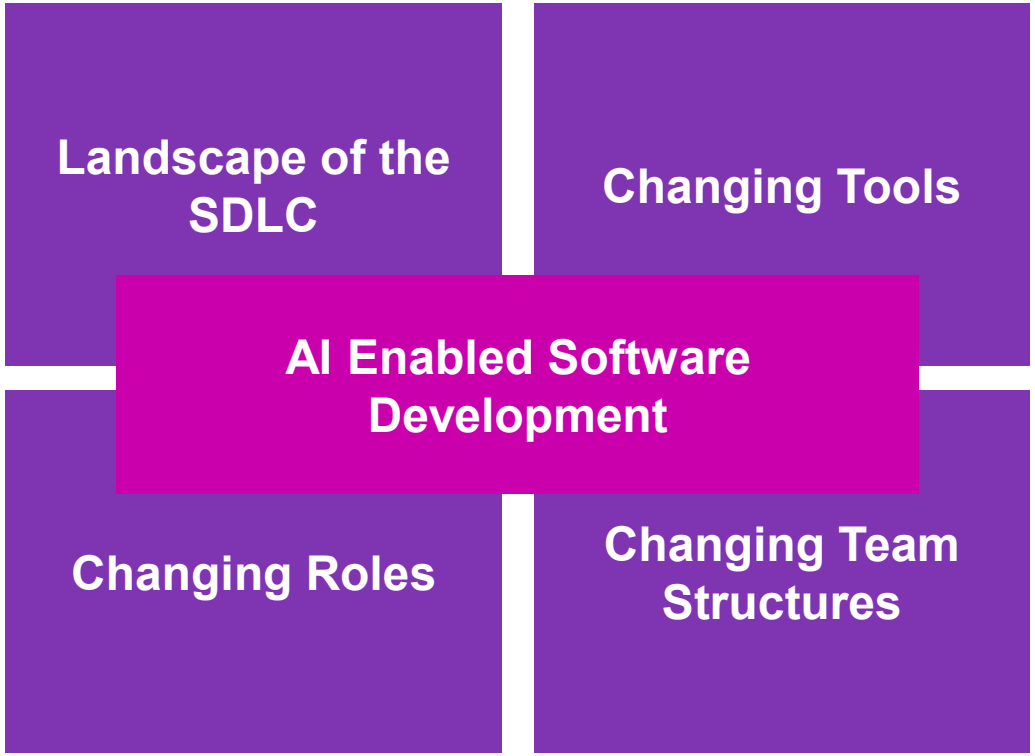
What about individuals?

We've talked through 4 different changes:



Resilience = Ability to adapt + Maintain effectiveness through change

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What about individuals?

Skill Diversity
Mix of technical, domain, and AI skills

Learning Culture
Continuous upskilling and experimentation

Adaptable Processes
Flexible frameworks that evolve with tools

Human-AI Balance
Clear roles for humans and AI systems

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What to look for in hiring

More

Problem solving aptitude

Adaptability and learning agility

Communication and collaboration

Critical thinking

AI tool awareness (to a degree)

Data analysis skills

Systems thinking

Less

Single tool deep experience (or single language)

Rigid approach to test processes

Individual heroics

Fearful of change

Key Interview Question: ***How would you use AI to solve this testing problem?***

Not: Can you write me an automated test script for this problem

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Key takeaways

Test is not dead – it's transforming
but this is nothing new

AI innovations are moving fast
Invest time in continual learning, but be mindful of riding every wave

Agentic AI is still new
Human in the loop is key, ecosystem lock-in may not be beneficial

Individual and Teams are changing
AI fluency and critical thinking is key
Quality Enablement is emerging

"It is not the strongest of the species that survives, nor the most intelligent, but the one most responsive to change"
Leon C. Megginson (1963) referring to Charles Darwin's Origin of Species

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